



Nokia E50

“Sleek, elegant, and Sexecutive” is what comes to mind when one first looks at the new Nokia E50. The phone has a nice, sturdy feel to it. The display is stunningly clear. The keypad has slightly bevelled keys, but feel cramped. The joystick provides good feedback.

Oriented towards business users, the E50 comes with



support for most mail protocols, and setting up an account is simple. PIM functions are also available, and synchronise with MS Outlook. There's a 1.3 MP camera, a decent MP3 player, and 70 MB of onboard memory, with support for a microSD memory card (not included).

At a street price of Rs 13,000, the E50 is a great buy if you are looking for an elegant, executive-class phone.

Specifications

Weight: 104 gm; screen: 262K colour, 320 x 240 TFT

Contact: Nokia
Phone: 0124-5199000
Web site: www.nokia.com
Price: Rs 15,539

RATINGS

Performance	★★★★☆
Features	★★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★★
Value for money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

Seagate Pushbutton Backup 750 GB

The Backup Behemoth

The newest Seagate Pushbutton Backup class of drives boasts a gigantic 750 GB capacity. Construction is rugged, and it comes with a stand to keep it in the upright position. When stacked horizontally one above the other, each drive locks with the one above and below it. In addition to the USB 2.0 port, the drive has two FireWire ports, so you can connect multiple drives in a daisy-chain.

The drive disappoints somewhat on the performance front: read speed is as expected, but the write speed was a bit slow. The bundled software

includes data backup software, in conjunction with which the drive's push-button conveniently backs up data. The bundled DiscWizard adequately performs drive maintenance functions.

The drive is priced too steep right now—if you need an external backup solution, you'd be well-advised to wait a couple of months.

Specifications

750 GB; 7200 rpm; 16 MB buffer; dimensions: 180 x 165 x 58 mm; weight: 1.27 kg; USB 2.0, FireWire400

Contact: Seagate Technologies
Phone: 044-42243353



E-mail: ramprasad.md@redington.co.in
Web site: www.seagate.com
Price: Rs 25,500

RATINGS

Performance	★★★★☆
Features	★★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★★
Value for money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

Zebronics ZEB-9000 HMV

Vibrating cans!

The 900 HMV are full ear-cup USB-based headphones that use the C-Media CMI108 chipset. Yes, that's right—you don't need a sound card or even onboard sound to use these headphones! And best of all, they're plug-n-play, though you'll need drivers to configure the inbuilt 5.1 surround sound capabilities.

Though these cans look heavy, they're pretty light without sacrificing on build quality.

It was a pleasant surprise to note that sound quality is really good: well-produced, deep bass, and the vocals crisp and distinguished—just the way we like our music! The extreme highs are slightly weak, but you will rarely feel the loss under most usage scenarios.

Sadly, the headphones are rather uncomfortable for long music sessions, and after around three



hours of use, we found our ears complaining. Though the vibration feature is little more than a gimmick—enabling it gives an impression of bass boost via vibrations—it isn't uncomfortable to have a ear massage while listening to music, but this does get irritating after a

while. The only scenario where the vibration could add to the immersive experience is while gaming. The Xear3D surround engine has been incorporated for this very purpose.

Volume levels are really high, and you'll rarely need to go anywhere beyond 50 per cent of what these cans are capable of belting out. Just as well, since you'll encounter distortion beyond

85 per cent of the max volume level—this is rather normal for most headphones.

Specifications

USB Interface, integrated C-Media CMI108 chipset, 5.1 Xear3D surround sound, vibration mode.

Contact: Top Notch Infotronics (I) Pvt Ltd
Phone: 044-26616202
E-mail: zebronics@zebronics.com
Web site: www.zebronics.com
Price: Rs 1,800

RATINGS

Performance	★★★★☆
Features	★★★★★
Ease of use	★★★★★
Value for money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★